Government Operations and Continuity Facility-Class Design Basis

The First Facility Class of the Government Facilities Sector Design Basis

DBA-GF-GO-FC1 — Facility-Class Design Basis, DBA-GF Series

Issued Under: Government Facilities Sector Framework (DBA-GF_Sector_Framework v0.3); DBA-MA Parent Framework

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This version is a member of CIKR Design Basis Examples, Edition 1 (November 2026) (https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.23863986), a dated edition that freezes, for each of fifteen critical infrastructure sectors, a sector framework, a facility class and a reference event as they stood on 1 November 2026. The edition is not falsified by a later revision of this document, whose working master continues to move. It is a working draft, marked DRAFT on its cover.

1. Purpose and Scope

1.1 Purpose

This document sets out the design basis for government operations and continuity, the first facility class in the DBA-GF series. The *Government Facilities Sector Framework* (DBA-GF_Sector_Framework) states the sector's design basis in general terms, and this document applies it to one kind of facility: the building, campus or operations center in which a government at any level does its business, makes its laws or keeps itself in being when its ordinary seat is lost. It names the events such a facility must withstand, traces how each event reaches the function the facility houses and the public it serves, sets the parameters that size the class's protection, and states what must be true of a facility, of the people in it and of the records and systems it runs on for the governance function to continue. It describes no particular building. A design basis for a specific building, capitol or continuity site starts from this document and adds only what is particular to it.

The framework sets two features apart in this sector. The first is that a government facility's value is the governance function it houses and not the structure, so that its consequence is the loss of a function, measured as the interval over which the function must be preserved or restored before it fails, with continuity of government as the bounding case (framework §1.5, §3.6). The second is that many of its facilities carry a symbolic consequence that no other sector carries: an attack for its effect on national morale and legitimacy, measured by the significance of the site and not by any recovery time (framework §1.5, §3.6). It therefore requires two consequence measures, one of which is not a duration. This document takes both up for the government-operations function, which the framework names first (framework §3.2). On the author's decisions of 14 October 2026 the class is the sector's first and proposes three reference events of its own (Section 9.2).

1.2 Scope

The class covers the facilities the framework's register names for the function: executive and administrative office buildings, operations centers, legislative facilities and capitols, and the continuity-of-government facilities that preserve the functioning of government under attack, at the federal, state, local and tribal levels (framework §3.2, §8.2). For a facility it covers the building and its site, including the distance between the building and any place a vehicle can reach; the people in it, who are officials and employees, members of the public who come to do business with their government, and others the building houses, among them children in its day-care centers; the governing acts performed there, among them those the law requires to be performed at a stated time or place; the enterprise systems and records on which the government does its business, whether they run in the building or elsewhere; the protective force that secures the facility and the authority by which that force can be reinforced; and the alternate site to which the function moves when its seat is lost. It includes the facility's openness to the public,

because for this function access is part of the service and cannot be closed off as a matter of course.

Three neighbors are separate classes of this series. Courthouses and the judicial operations they house are *Judicial Facilities* (DBA-GF-JU-FC2); where a government's enterprise systems also serve its courts, the court's function is that class's and the shared systems are both classes'. Voting systems, tabulation, voter registration and election management are *Election Infrastructure* (DBA-GF-EL-FC3), which takes up the breach of the Illinois voter-registration system of 2016 when it is written (Section 9.2). The mandated custodial control the General Services Administration, the Interagency Security Committee, the Federal Protective Service and the continuity programs hold over these facilities is the coordination class, DBA-GF-CntlCo. They are covered here only where a government-operations facility depends on them. Section 8.3 states the boundaries.

Three boundaries with other series are drawn in the framework and taken here as given. Emergency operations centers belong to Emergency Services, not to this sector, and the response forces that come to a government facility under attack are that series' (framework §6.3). Military installations and national laboratories appear in this sector as facilities but are governed for their defense-production and research functions by the defense-industrial-base series (framework §6.3). And the influence dimension of an attack on governance belongs to the surveillance and democratic-safeguards standard, which governs what the attack on the facility does not (framework §6.3).

What makes a facility a member of this class is the same at every level: it houses a governance function that the public depends on and that the law may require to be performed on time, it is open to the people it serves, and its loss is measured by the function and not by the building. The particular function, building and jurisdiction differ from site to site, and that detail belongs in each facility's own design basis.

1.3 The Reference Facilities

Three kinds of facility are used as reference cases. Each was chosen because it shows a different way the governance function can be lost.

The multi-tenant federal office building houses the field offices of several agencies, often with services the public visits in person and with other tenants, among them day-care centers, credit unions and recruiting offices, in a single structure on an urban street. It is the governing configuration for the life-safety consequence and for the building's own structural robustness, because the building is the place where the people are. The bombing of the Alfred P. Murrah Federal Building in Oklahoma City on 19 April 1995, conferred by the framework as DBA-GF-RE-1 (framework §9.1), is the case (Section 5.2).

The legislative seat is a capitol in which a legislature meets, and at which the law requires certain acts to be performed at a stated time: the counting of electoral votes, the passage of a budget, the swearing-in of officials. It is the governing configuration for the governance-continuity

consequence when the act itself is the target, and for the symbolic consequence, because the building is a national or state icon as well as a workplace. The breach of the United States Capitol on 6 January 2021, during the joint session of Congress convened to count the electoral votes, conferred by the framework as DBA-GF-RE-2 (framework §9.1), is the case (Section 5.3).

The municipal enterprise is the city or county government whose departments, from water billing to procurement to corrections, run on enterprise systems that the government itself operates. It is the reference for the loss of the function without the loss of the building, and for local government, which carries most of the public's daily business with its government and the least protection. The ransomware attack on the City of Atlanta that the city disclosed on 22 March 2018, conferred by the framework as DBA-GF-RE-3 (framework §9.1), is the case (Section 5.4).

1.4 Class Type

This is a coordination facility class under the author's determination of 30 September 2026 (*Facility-Class Types Are Physical, Coordination and Logical*), confirmed by the author's determination of 14 October 2026 (*Three Author Decisions: Continuity Classes, Vendor Releases and Staged Releases*). It holds the continuity of operations and continuity of government functions, and its substance is the continuity of governing authority, which is where the Command Broker sits. v0.1 typed it physical, and the author ruled it coordination; the class's treatment of the seat stays where it is, because the seat is the facility the coordination function runs from, and the harm that runs through buildings, their sites and the people in them is stated here as the seat's. In the framework's structure it sits under Government Operations and Continuity (GO), the first of the sector's three function classes (framework §3.1, §3.2). It carries one thing that sets it apart from the physical classes of the producer sectors: the function it houses can be moved. A government whose seat is lost can govern from elsewhere if it has prepared to, and its records and systems can be restored if they were kept where the loss did not reach. The class therefore states the alternate site and the recoverability of the records as design-basis quantities alongside the seat's own protection, and it states the loss of the enterprise systems, which needs no damage to the building, within the same class.

1.5 Relationship to Governing Documents

This instrument is issued under the Government Facilities Sector Framework and inherits the DBA-MA parent framework. It does not repeat the framework's taxonomy, bounding principles, governance-continuity and symbolic consequences or Bright Line and Command Broker architecture; it inherits them, and Section 9 is the required inheritance map. Where the framework is still a skeleton (framework §4, §5 and §7), this instrument develops the class-level content ahead of it and records in Section 9 what the framework should take up. Section references of the form framework §N resolve against the Government Facilities Sector Framework in force.

Governing instruments. This instrument does not own the concepts it applies. The Bright Line — its placement criterion, its granularity, its scope of application and the obligation it creates — is

defined in FD-BL (*The Bright Line*), which governs. The Broker role that discharges that obligation is defined in FD-BR (*The Broker*). Layer decomposition, the determinism boundary as a scope gate, and the machine-learning carve-out are defined in FD-LD (*Layer Decomposition and Determinism*). Local sovereignty is defined in FD-LS (*Local Sovereignty*). Two determinations bind under FD-BL: FD-BL-D1 (*Mode of Discharge*) governs how the authorization obligation may be discharged, and FD-BL-D2 (*Indication Integrity*) governs the integrity of the basis on which an authorization is granted. FD-EV (*Envelope*) reserves the term envelope. Placement is on the consequence of the individual action, assessed per action; this instrument applies that definition and does not vary it. The Foundational Definitions are cited without a version token, and FD-REG (*Governing Stack Register*) is authoritative for their version state.

2. The Government Operations and Continuity Facility Class

2.1 Defining Characteristics

Six characteristics define the class, and each is a reason the loss of a government facility reaches farther than the loss of most buildings.

The first is openness. A government must be reachable by the people it governs. Its offices are on public streets, its legislative galleries are open, and its services are given at a counter. The design basis cannot rest on closing the facility, because a closed government facility has already lost part of its function.

The second is co-tenancy. A single building commonly houses several agencies, the public they serve and tenants that are not government at all. The people at risk in an attack on one agency include everyone the building holds, and the protection of the building is set by its most exposed tenant, not by the one that owns it.

The third is that the function can move. A governance function is performed by people, with authority and records, and not by a building. Where the people survive, the authority is preserved and the records can be reached, the function can be performed from an alternate site; where any of the three is lost, it cannot. Continuity of government is the preparation for that move (framework §3.2).

The fourth is the time-bound act. Some governing acts must be performed by a stated time or at a stated place: a count the Constitution and statute schedule, a budget a charter requires, a payroll, a court date. An attack timed to such an act, or a disruption that runs past its deadline, reaches the function in a way that the same disruption at another time would not.

The fifth is the symbolic value. A capitol, a monument or the headquarters of a government is attacked for what it stands for as well as for what happens in it, and the harm of the attack is to the confidence of the public in its government, which no restoration of the building returns (framework §1.5).

The sixth is the enterprise. A government does its daily business on systems it runs itself: billing, permits, procurement, payroll, records of arrest and detention, the case systems of its courts. They are seldom built or funded to the standard of the infrastructure sectors, and at the local level they are often older than the threat they face. Their loss can stop a government's business without touching a building.

2.2 The Level and Classification Sub-Index

The framework sub-indexes the sector's classes by level of government and by security classification (framework §3.1, §8.2). This instrument states three tiers for the governance-continuity consequence and carries the symbolic consequence as a separate overlay, because the framework declines to measure the second in the terms of the first (framework §3.6). A facility's tier and its symbolic overlay are stated separately and are not averaged.

On the governance-continuity consequence, the first tier is the facility that is the seat of the executive or legislature of a jurisdiction, that houses a function the law requires to be performed at a stated time or place, or that is a designated continuity site for such a function, at any level of government. The second tier is the multi-tenant facility that the Interagency Security Committee's process assigns to a high facility security level, or its state or local equivalent, and the facility whose enterprise systems carry a jurisdiction's essential functions. The third tier is every other facility in the class.

The symbolic overlay is stated by the significance of the site: national, where the site stands for the nation; state or regional, where it stands for a state, a tribe or a region; and none. A facility can be third-tier for continuity and national on the overlay, as a monument with no governing function is, or first-tier for continuity and carry no overlay at all, as a county operations building may. Security classification is stated alongside, because a classified facility carries the information-security regime the framework names (framework §2.2) and a design basis that states its values must be held at the level of what it states.

2.3 Deployment Typologies and Size Range

The class spans several kinds of facility. A federal office building, owned or leased by the General Services Administration, houses field offices of several agencies under the security standards of the Interagency Security Committee, with the Federal Protective Service as its protective force. A capitol houses a legislature, and often an executive, under a protective force of its own: at the federal level the United States Capitol Police under the Capitol Police Board, at the state level a state police or capitol police. A city hall or county building houses a local government and its council, and the systems that run its departments, often protected by the local police. A continuity site is held ready, and sometimes held secret, for the move of a function when its seat is lost. And an operations center houses a government's watch over its own business, whose loss blinds it without stopping it.

The range is wide. At one end is the national capitol in session during a constitutionally scheduled act, with thousands of people inside and the nation watching; at the other a small town hall with a clerk, a council chamber and a single server. The class is written to fit both, because the consequence of either is measured in the governance function its public loses.

2.4 Consequence Context

The class's consequence runs on the two measures the framework requires (framework §3.6), and one more that the framework names without measuring. On governance continuity it is the interval over which a function is interrupted against the interval over which it must be preserved or restored before it fails. On the symbolic overlay it is a discrete harm to legitimacy and confidence, measured by the significance of the site. And for this class, which holds the public as well as its officials, it is also the harm to the people in the facility, which every government facility carries and which this instrument states as a chain of its own (Section 3.2).

The record shows all three. On 19 April 1995 a truck bomb detonated outside the Murrah Federal Building in Oklahoma City killed 168 people, nineteen of them children, many of whom had been left at the building's day-care center that morning, and injured 759, on the Oklahoma State Department of Health's count (*JAMA* 276, 1996), and roughly half of the building's floor space collapsed; the agencies it housed, among them the Social Security Administration, the Department of Housing and Urban Development, the Drug Enforcement Administration and the Bureau of Alcohol, Tobacco and Firearms, lost their offices, their records and many of their people (Section 5.2). On 6 January 2021 the joint session convened to count the electoral votes was interrupted when the Capitol was breached; the Senate Press Gallery's floor log records that it stood in recess at 2:13 p.m., returned at 8:06 p.m., and adjourned at 3:44 a.m. on 7 January, the count having been completed (Section 5.3). And from 22 March 2018 the City of Atlanta's municipal court could not take payments or validate warrants, its corrections department processed detainees by hand, and its departments did their business on paper, with no building damaged at all (Section 5.4).

3. The Facility-Class Design Envelope

3.1 Why Government Operations Is the First Class

Three reasons put this class first. It is the function the framework names first and whose bounding case, continuity of government, calibrates the governance-continuity duration for the whole sector (framework §3.2, §3.6). It is the class in which both of the sector's distinguishing consequences meet, since a seat of government is both the place where governance is performed and, at every level, a symbol of it. And it is the class whose events the plan for closing the seven sectors named: a bombing of a federal office building, the breach of a legislative seat during a scheduled act, and, on the author's decision of 14 October 2026, a destructive attack on a city's enterprise systems. The breach of the Illinois voter-registration system, which the plan also named, belongs to the election class, and is held for it (Section 9.2). The judicial and election

classes, whose consequences are the rule of law and the integrity of elections, are left to their own instruments.

3.2 The Three Consequence Chains

Every event in the class reaches the public by one of three chains. The first is the framework's governance-continuity consequence; the second is the harm to people that every government facility carries and that this instrument separates because it is reached and bounded differently; the third is the framework's symbolic consequence, which is not a duration.

Chain G, the governance chain, begins with something that removes the capacity to perform a governance function: the loss of the facility, of the people who perform the function, of the authority by which they act, or of the records and systems on which they act. The public receives no permit, payment, benefit, law or decision for as long as the function takes to restore at its seat or to move to another. Its consequence is measured in the interval of interruption against the interval the function can bear, which for a time-bound act is set by its deadline.

Chain L, the life-safety chain, begins with an attack or hazard that reaches the people in the facility: officials, employees, members of the public and the others the building houses. Its consequence is measured in lives and injuries, and it is bounded by the building's structure, by the separation between the building and the places an attacker can reach, by the protective force and by the means of escape. It is carried by every occupied building, but in this class the occupants are chosen, by the attacker who chooses a government facility, for what they serve.

Chain S, the symbolic chain, begins with an attack whose purpose is its effect on the nation's confidence in its government. Nothing need be destroyed for it to run: a seat of government entered and held, even for hours, carries the consequence whether or not the function was interrupted. Its consequence is measured by the significance of the site and is not reversed by any restoration (framework §3.6).

The three chains are joined by the facility's openness, since the access through which the public reaches its government is the access through which an attacker reaches the people and the seat. And they are joined by timing: an attack on a seat during a time-bound act opens all three at once.

3.3 Design Parameters at Class Resolution

Six parameters govern the envelope.

The first is the governance-continuity duration: for each function a facility houses, the longest interruption the function can bear before it fails, and, for a time-bound act, the time between the latest point at which the act can resume and its legal deadline. It is this instrument's statement of the framework's governance-continuity duration at class resolution (framework §3.6). Federal executive-branch continuity programs, under Presidential Policy Directive 40 and Federal Continuity Directive 1, plan to resume essential functions within twelve hours of a continuity

activation and to sustain them for at least thirty days or until normal operations resume; that is one calibration of the parameter, for the federal executive, and the class does not assume it for other levels or for legislatures.

The second is the relocation time: the time to perform each function from its alternate site, with its people, its authority and its records, measured from the loss of its seat. It is the parameter that makes the third characteristic of Section 2.1 a design-basis quantity, and a function with no alternate site has a relocation time equal to the restoration of its seat.

The third is the standoff and structural robustness: the distance between the building and the nearest point a vehicle or a person carrying a device can reach unscreened, and the building's capacity to lose an element of its structure without the progressive collapse of what that element supported. It is the parameter on which Chain L most depends, and the record of Section 5.2 shows why both halves of it are needed. Robustness is measured by the people it protects: for each element a blast at the stated standoff could remove, the floor area that depends on it and that area's occupant load at the most occupied hour are stated, because at Oklahoma City 153 of the 175 people in the part of the building that collapsed died, and 10 of the 186 in the part that stood (*The Bombing of the Alfred P. Murrah Federal Building* F-1, R-1).

The fourth is the occupant load: the number of people the facility holds when it is most occupied, by kind, including the public and those, such as children, who cannot escape unaided. It sizes Chain L and sets the protection the facility needs. Those who cannot escape unaided are placed, not only counted: the design basis states where they are held relative to the faces a vehicle can reach and the dependent area of the third parameter, and treats their exposure there as a stated shortfall (*The Bombing of the Alfred P. Murrah Federal Building* F-2, R-2; noted to CntlCo).

The fifth is the reinforcement time: the time from the moment the facility's protective force judges that it cannot hold to the moment reinforcement with the authority to act arrives, including the time taken to request and to approve it. It is the parameter that the record of Section 5.3 shows to be governed less by distance than by authority. It is the sum of two chains, the requesting chain and the answering chain, each with its approvals. At the Capitol the Board approved the request at 2:10 p.m., after the attack had begun, and the Guard began arriving nearly three hours after the Department of Defense received it; the law Congress passed in December 2021 shortened only the first chain (*The Breach of the United States Capitol* F-1). A shorter request alone is not credited (*The Breach of the United States Capitol* R-1; noted to CntlCo and *Response Forces and Stations*).

The sixth is the records recoverability: the fraction of the records and systems on which each function depends that can be restored, from copies the event did not reach, within the function's governance-continuity duration, and the fraction that cannot be restored at all. It sets how far Chain G can run when the systems are attacked, and the record of Section 5.4 shows that some of a government's records may be lost for good. Only copies and rebuilds the government controls count toward it, and no payment is credited toward any governance-continuity duration (*The Ransomware Attack on the City of Atlanta* F-1, R-1). The inventory of systems carries each

system's criticality to each function, is kept and tested, and is the first-day assessment of what is lost, because Atlanta's own estimate rose in three months from a fifth of its programs, none critical, to a third, nearly thirty percent of them mission-critical (*The Ransomware Attack on the City of Atlanta* F-2, R-2; noted to *Judicial Facilities* and *Software, Hardware and Product Supply Chain*).

This instrument states the parameters and their governing logic. Their quantitative values for a facility await validation against what the government already holds: the assessments made under the Interagency Security Committee's risk management process, the continuity plans of each organization, the vulnerability and resilience assessments CISA offers to state and local governments, and the facilities' own records. Some of those values are controlled or classified, which is why they are not asserted here and why a facility's design basis that states them must be held at the level of what it states (Section 10.1). The figures quoted are their sources' own.

4. The Seat, the Act and the Records

4.1 Status and Use

Every event in this class reaches the governance function through one of three things the facility keeps: its seat, the building and site in which the function is performed and the people who perform it; the act, the governing acts performed there and the authority by which they are performed and defended; and the records, the systems and records on which the function acts. They are the class's governing pathway, and this section states what the class requires of each. It is written as the receiving function of the hospital class, DBA-HPH-CD-FC1 (*Care Delivery*), and the production line and technical data package of the defense class, DBA-DIB-DP-FC1 (*Defense Production and Sustainment*), are written, because the seat, the act and the records are the facility's interfaces with the public it serves and with the attacker who would deny or exploit it.

4.2 The Essential Function as a Design-Basis Quantity

A government facility's continuity plan is usually regarded as an administrative matter. In this class the essential function is a design-basis quantity, because the public's design basis for everything else, from emergency coordination to the payment of benefits, counts on it. The class requires that a first-tier facility's design basis state, for each function it houses, the governance-continuity duration of Section 3.3; for each time-bound act, the act's deadline and the latest point at which it can resume; the alternate site from which the function can be performed and its relocation time; and what the move depends on: the people and their succession, the delegations of authority, and the records. It requires that an alternate site be credited only if the function has been performed from it, in an exercise or in fact, and not from the date it was designated. The federal executive's continuity programs supply the method (Section 8.4); legislatures and local governments, which those programs do not bind, are within the class all the same. The instruments of a time-bound act are records: for each such act the design basis states its physical

instruments, their custody during the act, their removal with the people performing it, and whether the act may resume on copies, because on 6 January 2021 the count rested on the paper certificates, which floor staff carried from the chamber on a senator's statement of the day (*The Breach of the United States Capitol* F-2, R-2; noted to *Election Infrastructure*).

4.3 Standoff and the Structure

A building's protection against a bomb rests on two things that cannot substitute for each other: the distance the bomb is kept from the building, and the building's capacity to lose part of its structure without the rest falling. The class requires that a first- or second-tier facility's design basis state its standoff on every side a vehicle can reach and the structural robustness of Section 3.3, and that each be justified against the threat the Interagency Security Committee's process or its state or local equivalent assigns to the facility. Where a building in service cannot be given the standoff its threat requires, as an urban building on a public street often cannot, the class requires that the shortfall be stated and that the structure, the closure of the adjacent street or the relocation of the most exposed occupants be considered against it. The record of Section 5.2 shows why: the structure of the Murrah building was found adequate for the codes to which it was designed, and those codes did not ask it to survive the loss of the columns the bomb removed.

4.4 The Authority to Reinforce

A facility's protective force is sized for its ordinary day. On the day it is overrun, the time to reinforce it is set by who may ask for help, who must approve the asking, and who must approve the answer. The class requires that a first-tier facility's design basis state, for the event its protective force cannot hold alone, who may request reinforcement and on what judgment, whether that request needs any further approval and from whom, which forces can answer and on whose authority they deploy, and the reinforcement time of Section 3.3 that results. It requires that the chain of authority be exercised, and that no step in it depend on a person or body that the event itself may prevent from acting. The record of Section 5.3 shows what an unstated chain costs, and the law that followed it shows the chain can be shortened (Section 8.4). The reinforcement time is stated as the requesting and the answering chain together, and the answering chain is exercised with the force that would answer (Section 3.3).

4.5 The Records and Their Recovery

A government's enterprise systems are usually regarded as a matter of information technology. In this class they are a design-basis asset, because a government that cannot reach its records cannot perform its function wherever its people sit. The class requires that a first- or second-tier facility's design basis state, for each function, the systems and records it depends on, where copies are held, whether any event that reaches the systems can also reach the copies, and the records recoverability of Section 3.3. It requires that copies from which essential records can be restored be kept where an intrusion into the government's networks cannot alter or delete them,

that their restoration be tested within the function's governance-continuity duration, and that records which cannot be restored be identified before they are lost and not after. The record of Section 5.4 shows that a city can restore its services over months and still lose, for good, evidence that its police had kept for years.

4.6 Openness Under Threat

When the threat to a facility rises, the instinct is to close it. Closing a government facility ends part of its function, and closing it on every threat hands the attacker that result without an attack. The class requires that the basis for restricting public access to a first-tier facility, for screening more closely, for closing parts of it, and for closing it altogether, be stated before it is needed, so that a restriction is a governed decision by a qualified human on a stated basis and not an improvisation. It does not state the basis, which is the jurisdiction's; it requires that the basis exist and that the information on which it acts be trustworthy (Section 7.3).

5. Design Basis Events: The Envelope

The events below are the class's design-basis envelope, each stated with the event postulated, the consequence threshold, the function the class requires and the duration for which it is required. Each is marked by the chain or chains it opens. Section 5.1 is non-adversarial; Section 5.6 may be either; Sections 5.2, 5.3, 5.4, 5.5, 5.7 and 5.8 are adversarial. Inclusion is by governance-consequence severity, not likelihood (framework §4.1).

5.1 Loss of the Seat by Fire, Natural Hazard or Failure

Postulated event a fire, flood, wind, earthquake or failure of the building's structure or services makes a first- or second-tier facility unusable, with or without harm to the people in it.

Consequence threshold the interruption of every function the facility houses until it is restored or moved (Chain G), and harm to its occupants (Chain L).

Required function the means of escape and the fire protection act independently of any network an attacker could reach (Section 7.2); each function's alternate site and relocation time are stated and have been exercised (Section 4.2); and the records each function depends on can be reached from the alternate site.

Design-basis duration until each function is performed again, at its seat or its alternate site.

5.2 Vehicle-Borne Explosive Attack on an Occupied Building

Postulated event an attacker brings a vehicle carrying explosives to the nearest point it can reach to a first- or second-tier facility during working hours and detonates it.

Consequence threshold mass casualties among the occupants and the public, including the progressive collapse of the parts of the building whose support the blast removes (Chain L); the

loss of the functions housed, with their people and records (Chain G); and, at a facility of symbolic significance, the symbolic harm (Chain S).

Required function the standoff and structural robustness of Section 4.3 are stated against the facility's assigned threat, and any shortfall is stated with what is done about it; the occupant load, and those who cannot escape unaided, are stated; and the functions housed can be moved without the people and records the event took.

Design-basis duration the rescue and recovery of the occupants, and until each function is performed again.

The case is the bombing of the Alfred P. Murrah Federal Building in Oklahoma City on 19 April 1995, conferred by the framework as DBA-GF-RE-1 (framework §9.1), whose instrument records it as a non-military adversarial event. Just after nine in the morning a truck bomb, estimated in the investigation of the building's performance at about 4,000 pounds of TNT equivalent, was detonated at the curb on the building's north side, about sixteen feet from the nearest column. It killed 168 people, nineteen of them children, many of whom had been brought to the building's day-care center that morning, and injured 759, on the Oklahoma State Department of Health's study (*JAMA* 276, 1996), which divides the dead by where they were: of the 175 people in the part of the building that collapsed, 153 died, and of the 186 in the part that stood, 10 died. The building housed field offices of several federal agencies, among them the Social Security Administration, the Department of Housing and Urban Development, the Department of Veterans Affairs, the Drug Enforcement Administration and the Bureau of Alcohol, Tobacco and Firearms, together with a federal employees' credit union and military recruiting offices. Those responsible were tried and convicted, and no individual is named here.

The investigation of the building's performance, as the National Institute of Standards and Technology summarizes it, found that the blast destroyed columns supporting a transfer girder at the third floor, that the loss of that support led to the progressive collapse of the floors above, and that roughly half of the building's usable space collapsed; that the building, an ordinary reinforced-concrete frame, had been designed adequately to the codes in force at the time, which did not ask it to resist blast; and that detailing of the kind used in seismic regions would, on the investigating team's estimate, have reduced the area that collapsed by between half and four-fifths. The government's response reshaped the protection of federal buildings. The Department of Justice's *Vulnerability Assessment of Federal Facilities* of 28 June 1995 sorted federal facilities into five security levels and set minimum standards for each, and Executive Order 12977 of 19 October 1995 established the Interagency Security Committee to set standards for the security of federal facilities, which it still does. The design-basis reading is that a building on a public street, open to the public and designed as an ordinary office, was the place where a government's field offices, its public and its employees' children were together, and that the collapse of the structure, and not the blast alone, set how much of the building and of the people in it were lost, so that standoff and structural robustness are both design-basis quantities and neither can substitute for the other. The instrument states the government's findings as its own.

5.3 Breach of a Seat During a Governing Act

Postulated event a crowd or an armed group overcomes the protective force of a first-tier facility and enters it while a time-bound act is being performed there, so that the act is interrupted and the people performing it must be protected or moved.

Consequence threshold the interruption of the act, and, if it cannot resume before its deadline, the failure of the function (Chain G); harm to the officials, staff, protective force and others in the facility (Chain L); and the symbolic harm of the seat entered and held (Chain S).

Required function the chain of authority to reinforce is stated and exercised, and the reinforcement time is shorter than the time the protective force can hold (Section 4.4); the people performing the act can be moved to a protected place within the facility or outside it, with what they need to resume; and the act can resume, at its seat or elsewhere, before its deadline.

Design-basis duration from the breach until the act is completed and the facility is secured.

The case is the breach of the United States Capitol on 6 January 2021, conferred by the framework as DBA-GF-RE-2 (framework §9.1), whose instrument records it as a non-military adversarial event, precision and denial not determined. Congress met in joint session that afternoon to count the electoral votes of the 2020 presidential election, an act the Constitution and statute schedule. A crowd that had gathered nearby overcame the police lines and entered the building. The Senate Press Gallery's floor log records that the Senate stood in recess at 2:13 p.m., returned at 8:06 p.m., and adjourned at 3:44 a.m. on 7 January, the count having been completed in the night. The Department of Justice has stated that about 140 police officers were assaulted that day.

The official reviews of the event are several, and they differ. The Senate's Committee on Homeland Security and Governmental Affairs and Committee on Rules and Administration, in a joint bipartisan report of June 2021, *Examining the U.S. Capitol Attack*, confined to the security, planning and response, found failures of intelligence and of planning; found that the Capitol Police had no department-wide operational plan for the day and that many of its officers lacked training and equipment for civil disturbance; found that the members of the Capitol Police Board in charge on January 6 did not fully understand the statutory and regulatory requirements for requesting National Guard support, which contributed to the delay; and recorded that the Board issued an emergency declaration and approved a request for the Guard at 2:10 p.m., after the attack had begun, and that the Guard was authorized to deploy, after requests and approvals at several levels, and began arriving at the Capitol at about 5:20 p.m. The House's Select Committee to Investigate the January 6th Attack, in its final report of December 2022, made findings, which are its own, that the then-President's effort to reverse the outcome of the election was the central cause of the event, and made findings on the security response as well. The Subcommittee on Oversight of the House's Committee on House Administration, in a report of December 2024, disputed the select committee's findings and attributed the delay in the Guard's response to decisions within the Department of the Army. On 20 January 2025 the President

granted pardons and commutations to those convicted of offenses in connection with the event, and directed the dismissal of the indictments still pending; and on 6 January 2026 the White House published an account of the day that holds the then-Speaker of the House and the civilian leadership of the Department of Defense and the Army responsible for the security failures, relying on the House subcommittee's work, describes many of those who entered as peaceful protesters, and disputes the select committee's account of the event. The instrument states each account as its authors' own and takes no position among them on causes or on conduct. The record is open: a House subcommittee began a further inquiry with public hearings in January 2026.

The design-basis reading rests on the security record. The Senate committees' bipartisan report records that the protective force of a legislative seat was overcome during a scheduled act, and that reinforcement arrived hours after it was requested, through a chain of requests and approvals whose requirements those in charge did not fully understand; the House subcommittee's report also records the Guard's delay, though it assigns the cause differently. The accounts differ on why the chain was slow and on who was responsible; the class does not need that answered to require that the chain be stated, exercised and short. Congress itself drew the same lesson in law in December 2021, when it allowed the Chief of the Capitol Police to request assistance without the Board's prior approval in an emergency (Section 8.4). The reading also records that the count resumed and was completed the same night, so that the time-bound act survived its interruption; the class requires that it be able to, and does not assume it will.

5.4 Destructive Attack on the Government Enterprise

Postulated event an attacker reaches a government's enterprise systems and encrypts, destroys or alters them, or the records they hold, so that the government's departments cannot do their business on them, with or without a demand for payment.

Consequence threshold the interruption of every function that runs on the systems, across the government's departments, until they are restored or worked around by hand (Chain G); and the permanent loss of records that cannot be restored, which can reach rights and proceedings that depend on them.

Required function the records recoverability of Section 3.3 is stated for each function, and copies of essential records are kept where the intrusion cannot reach them and have been restored in a test within the function's governance-continuity duration (Section 4.5); each department can do its essential business by hand for the time restoration takes; and the decision whether to restore, rebuild or pay is a governed decision made on a stated basis. No payment is credited toward recoverability, and the inventory of systems with their criticality is the first-day assessment (Section 3.3).

Design-basis duration until every essential function is performed again on restored or rebuilt systems, and, for records that cannot be restored, for as long as anything depends on them.

The case is the ransomware attack on the City of Atlanta, which the city disclosed on 22 March 2018, conferred by the framework as DBA-GF-RE-3 (framework §9.1). The indictment returned in Atlanta, announced by the United States Attorney for the Northern District of Georgia on 5 December 2018, alleges an intrusion from on or about 10 March 2018, about 3,789 of the city's computers encrypted, and a payment page that became inaccessible within days. On the city's own statement of 23 March, its municipal court could not take payments or validate warrants issued by the court, its corrections department processed detainees by hand, its watershed department could not process billing inquiries or new service requests, its procurement could not issue purchase orders, and the public wireless network at its airport was shut down as a precaution, while its police, fire and 911 services and the treatment of its water were unaffected. The demand was reported as about $51,000 in bitcoin, and the city is not reported to have paid it. Its recovery took months: as reported, about a third of its software programs were still offline or partly disabled in June 2018, the city committed about $2.7 million to emergency contracts for the response and later estimated it would need about $9.5 million more, and its police lost years of dashcam video for good. A city audit completed in January 2018, as reported, had found a large number of vulnerabilities in the city's systems.

On 28 November 2018 the Department of Justice announced that a grand jury in the District of New Jersey had indicted two Iranian nationals for a campaign of ransomware, known as SamSam, that on the Department's account had struck more than two hundred victims, among them the City of Atlanta, the City of Newark, the Port of San Diego and the Colorado Department of Transportation, as well as hospitals, collected more than $6 million and caused losses exceeding $30 million. The Department described the scheme as one to extort payment; it did not allege that the defendants acted for a government. They remain at large, the criminal record being two indictments, which are allegations, and open; the class follows that record under the RECORD PRIMACY convention of the DBA Reference Event Register, and no individual is named here. The design-basis reading is that a city government lost the use of its enterprise without the loss of a building or a life, that the services the public most depends on in an emergency were kept apart and survived, that the business of a whole government had to be done by hand for weeks, and that some of its records could not be restored at all, so that what a government cannot rebuild is the measure of its exposure. The instrument states the city's and the Department's accounts as their own.

5.5 Attack on the People Who Govern

Postulated event an attacker targets the officials who perform a governance function, at the facility, on the way to it or at their homes, so that a function loses the people who perform it or those people are prevented from acting.

Consequence threshold harm to the officials and those near them (Chain L); the interruption of the functions they perform until their successors act (Chain G); and, where the officials are prominent, the symbolic harm (Chain S).

Required function the succession and delegations of authority for each first-tier function are stated and current, so that no single loss removes the authority to act; and the protection of the officials who perform a first-tier function is stated with the facility's.

Design-basis duration until the function is performed by its officials or their successors.

This is the framework's continuity-of-government decapitation event at the scale of a single facility, and the governing military-action scenario of Section 6.3 is its scale for the nation (framework §4.1). The targeted violence against judges, which the framework names for the judicial class, is that class's (framework §3.3).

5.6 Loss of the Substrate

Postulated event a facility loses the power, communications, water or network services it depends on for longer than its own reserves last, through a hazard, a failure or an attack on the provider.

Consequence threshold the interruption of the functions that depend on the services (Chain G), and, where life-safety systems depend on them, harm to occupants (Chain L).

Required function the facility states which of its functions and protective systems depend on each service and for how long its reserves last; its life-safety systems do not depend on a service it cannot hold in reserve; and the function's alternate site does not depend on the same provider.

Design-basis duration until the service is restored or the functions are moved.

As a consumer sector the class inherits the design basis of its substrate from the energy, communications, information-technology, transportation and water series and does not restate it (framework §1.2, §6.1).

5.7 Chemical, Biological or Radiological Contamination

Postulated event an attacker introduces a hazardous agent into a facility, through its mail, its air intakes or its public spaces, so that it must be evacuated and decontaminated.

Consequence threshold harm to the people exposed (Chain L), and the loss of the facility for the time its decontamination takes, which can be long (Chain G).

Required function the facility's mail and deliveries are screened apart from its occupied spaces where the tier requires; its air-handling can be isolated; and its functions can be moved for the time decontamination takes.

Design-basis duration until the facility is decontaminated and reoccupied, or the functions are performed elsewhere for that time.

The letters containing anthrax that reached the Senate's offices in October 2001 closed a Senate office building for months, and are noted, not proposed.

5.8 The Insider

Postulated event a person with authorized access to a facility, its systems or its protective arrangements uses that access to harm the people, the function or the records, or gives it to someone who does.

Consequence threshold any of Chains G, L and S, reached past the protections that face outward.

Required function access to first-tier spaces, systems and protective arrangements is limited to what each person's work needs and is recorded; and no single person can disable the protection of a first-tier facility or delete the copies of its essential records.

Design-basis duration the period of access.

Table 5-1. Facility-class design-basis event categories.

Event category	Postulated event (class-specific)	Consequence chain	Framework source
Loss of the seat by fire, natural hazard or failure	Facility unusable	Chain G, Chain L	§4.1; developed here
Vehicle-borne explosive attack on an occupied building	Truck bomb at the nearest reachable point	Chain L, Chain G, Chain S	§4.1 candidate (symbolic-site attack); developed here
Breach of a seat during a governing act	Protective force overcome during a time-bound act	Chain G, Chain L, Chain S	§1.5, §3.2; developed here
Destructive attack on the government enterprise	Enterprise systems or records encrypted, destroyed or altered	Chain G	§2.1, §6.1; developed here
Attack on the people who govern	Officials targeted	Chain L, Chain G, Chain S	§4.1 candidate (decapitation)
Loss of the substrate	Power, communications, water or network lost	Chain G, Chain L	§1.2, §6.1
Chemical, biological or radiological contamination	Agent introduced by mail, air or public space	Chain L, Chain G	developed here
The insider	Authorized access misused	Chain G, Chain L, Chain S	developed here

6. Military-Action Extension: DBA-MA for Government Operations

6.1 MA Extension Applicability Determination

Every first-tier facility in the class, and every facility carrying a national symbolic overlay, performs the facility-level applicability determination the series makes mandatory, under the two-factor test of geolocation and strategic value, with strategic value driven by the governance function preserved and by symbolic significance (framework §7). The framework calls the sector a first-order military-action target and states a strong sector-level presumption toward applicability for continuity-of-government facilities and symbolic national sites (framework §7). For this class geolocation includes the reach of the weapons an adversary can bring to bear, which extends to a national capital far from any front, and the reach of its intelligence and cyber services into the government's networks, which has no distance at all. The determination is recorded, it is time-varying and re-triggered on the indicators the DBA-MA parent framework defines, and any scope reduction carries a recorded basis (Section 6.9).

6.2 The Four Characteristics Applied to the Class

Applied to government operations, the four military-action characteristics take specific form, in the canonical statement of FD-DBL (*Design Basis Layers*), at its §4.4. Intentionality: the adversary chooses the seat whose loss most disrupts the defender's ability to decide and to coordinate, and the site whose loss most shakes the public's confidence. Persistence: the adversary strikes the seats of government repeatedly, and holds access to its networks for as long as it can. Precision: the adversary chooses the moment when the people who decide are gathered, the continuity site whose location it has learned, and the records without which the government cannot act. Denial: the adversary seeks to prevent the government from governing for the time that matters to the conflict, by removing its people, its seat and its records together.

Under the author's rulings of 10 and 13 October 2026, the military-action tier is not met without denial, and all four characteristics must be established on the record; a characteristic not determined counts as not present (*Design Basis Layers* §6.4). None of the three conferred reference events is a military action: the first was a domestic terrorist attack, the second a breach by a crowd whose character the official reviews describe differently, and the third a criminal extortion scheme on the Department of Justice's account. The tier of each is its instrument's to determine.

6.3 The Seat Struck During the Conflict, as the Governing MA Scenario

The governing military-action scenario is a campaign against the defender's government during a war, by long-range strikes on its seats of government and operations centers, timed to when the people who decide are present, combined with a destructive attack on the enterprise systems and records on which the government would move and act. It opens Chains G, L and S together. No credit is taken for distance from the front, for the secrecy of a continuity site the adversary may have learned, or for copies of records the same campaign can reach.

The extension requires three things. It requires that each first-tier function be able to be performed from an alternate site that the same strike cannot reach, with people the same strike cannot remove and records the same intrusion cannot alter. It requires that succession and the delegations of authority be such that no strike the campaign can deliver removes the authority to act. And it requires that the people in a seat that is struck can reach protection within the warning time the facility can expect.

The empirical record is not among this class's proposed events, and it is noted rather than proposed. On 7 September 2025, in what was reported as the largest aerial attack of the war to that date, the building of Ukraine's Cabinet of Ministers in Kyiv was damaged, including its roof and upper floors, with smoke and fire reported; whether by a direct hit or by debris was not immediately clear. It was reported as the first time the government complex had been damaged since the full-scale invasion began. The Prime Minister of Ukraine said the buildings would be restored and that lost lives could not be brought back. Russia's Ministry of Defense said its strikes in Kyiv were on industrial and logistics targets and that no other targets within the city were struck. The design-basis reading is that a belligerent's seat of government in its capital has been struck in a war of this decade, and that the nation's own design basis must postulate that its seats can be. The record is the statements of both governments and the reporting of the day; the instrument states them as their own and makes no finding of intent or of effect beyond what its sources establish.

6.4 The Symbolic Strike

The second scenario is on the symbolic chain. An adversary strikes a site for what it stands for: a monument, a capitol, the headquarters of a government, on a date chosen for its meaning. The harm is to the nation's confidence and is not reduced by the speed of any restoration (framework §3.6). The class cannot bound it by any duration, and it states it as a declared residual (Section 6.8). What the class requires is that the facility's protection be set by its symbolic overlay as well as by its continuity tier, so that a site of national significance with no governing function is not protected as a third-tier building because nothing is governed there.

6.5 The Compound Scenario

The framework names among its candidate bounding events the continuity-of-government decapitation scenario (framework §4.1). For this class its compound form is a strike on a seat during a time-bound act, while the adversary holds access to the networks through which the government would relocate, authenticate its successors and reach its records, so that the move to the alternate site is itself attacked. Against it the class relies on alternate sites and records that the intrusion does not reach (Sections 4.2 and 4.5), on succession that does not depend on the networks to establish authority, and on the separation of the facility's life-safety systems from networks an adversary can reach (Section 7.2).

6.6 Cross-Sector Interaction

Under military action the class's outward consequence is the functioning of government itself, which coordinates every other sector's response and recovery (framework §6.2). Coming in, the class depends on energy, communications, information technology, transportation and water for its buildings and its systems (framework §6.1), and on Emergency Services for the forces that answer an attack on it. An adversary need not strike a seat of government to stop it governing: a campaign against its power, its networks or its records can be enough, which is why the enterprise is within this class and not only in the series that govern its substrate.

6.7 The Adequacy Result: Two Conditions

Because the framework measures the governance consequence in duration and declines to measure the symbolic consequence that way (framework §3.6), and because the class carries the life-safety chain alongside, the test of adequacy is two tests, and a facility meets the class design basis only if it meets both. The symbolic consequence is not tested; it is declared (Section 6.8).

The first is what this document calls the Continuity of Function Condition. When the facility's seat, the people at it and the systems it runs on are lost together in the design-basis event, each first-tier function is performed again, from its seat or its alternate site, by its officials or their successors, on records restored from copies the event did not reach, within its governance-continuity duration, and each time-bound act is completed before its deadline. The condition bounds Chain G by the relocation time and the records recoverability, and it is met only by alternate sites and restorations that have been exercised.

The second is what this document calls the Protected Occupancy Condition. When the facility is attacked in the design-basis event, the people in it, including the public and those who cannot escape unaided, are protected by the standoff and structure of Section 4.3, by a protective force reinforced within the time it can hold, and by means of escape and shelter that act whatever the state of the facility's networks. The condition bounds Chain L.

The protective functions on which an occupied government building relies in the moment are those that let its people escape and keep fire from spreading: the release of locked doors on the means of egress when the fire alarm sounds or power is lost, fire detection and suppression, and smoke control. Where they are protective functions in that sense they are to be locally sovereign as FD-LS defines the property (*Local Sovereignty* §3.2): a measurement against a setpoint, colocated with the hazard, which no system an attacker could reach can stop, delay or trigger, and whose settings change only through a governed act. Local Sovereignty governs and is not restated here. It describes what protects the occupants when the building's control systems have failed; it does not decide whether any action needs human authorization (*Local Sovereignty* §4). It has nothing to say about the governance chain, which no physical protection can bound.

6.8 Adequacy and the Declared Residual

In the non-adversarial domain, the Continuity of Function Condition is achievable with the Section 4 requirements: stated functions and deadlines, exercised alternate sites and tested restorations. Against a deliberate adversary, adequacy has limits.

Three residuals are declared, in the output form DBA-MA-DiD (*Defense in Depth*) sets at its §3.5. First, an attack that kills or injures people in a facility before any protection acts leaves a residual in lives that no later restoration of the function reduces; its measure is the occupant load reached, and the response is the standoff, the structure and the means of escape. Second, records destroyed with no copy beyond the attacker's reach are a residual without end in time; its measure is what depended on them, and the response is to identify such records before the event and to keep their copies apart. Third, the symbolic harm of a seat struck or entered is a residual that the class cannot bound in any measure it can state; it is declared here, by the significance of the site, so that it is not mistaken for a consequence the class has answered. These residuals bound the class adequacy claim.

6.9 Consequence-Basis Conditionality Check

Any relaxation of a conservative class parameter, such as an alternate site credited that has never been used, a continuity site credited as safe because its location is secret, copies of records credited that an intrusion into the same network could reach, standoff credited that a vehicle can close on a public street, a reinforcement time credited from distance alone without the time to request and approve, or a facility protected as third-tier because it governs nothing although it carries a national symbolic overlay, must be justified against the class baseline, and the larger the relaxation the stronger the analytical basis required. A relaxation without a recorded basis is not consistent with the class design basis. The framework does not yet state this principle for the sector, and Sections 9.1 and 10.9 record it for the framework to adopt.

7. The Dual Design Basis, Stated in Full

7.1 The Two Design Bases

The facility carries two design bases at once: a physical design basis, defined in this instrument, and an AI-governance design basis, governed by the Foundational Definitions and the Command Broker family and named and referenced here (framework §5). They interact at the point developed in Section 7.4.

7.2 The Physical Design Basis: The Determinism Posture

The physical design basis is the set of protective functions the facility relies on to keep its people safe independently of its networked systems: its standoff and structure; its vehicle barriers; its means of egress and the release of their locks; its fire detection, suppression and smoke control; the isolation of its air-handling and mail screening; and the protection of the copies of its

essential records. A door on a means of egress that unlocks when the fire alarm sounds or its power fails, with no networked controller able to hold it locked, is a candidate for a locally sovereign function. A function meets *Local Sovereignty* §3.2 only if no system an attacker could reach can stop, delay or trigger it, or change its settings except through a governed act.

Whether a function is deterministic decides whether the authorization rules apply to it at all. It does not decide where its actions fall on the Bright Line. Controllers that behave predictably within a stated range of inputs, and that have been formally tested in the deployed configuration, are outside the Command Broker obligation for the actions they take while their inputs stay in that range (*Layer Decomposition and Determinism* §4.3). That is a statement of scope, not of placement; they are outside the obligation only because, and only while, their behavior is bounded by that showing (*The Bright Line* §4.5). The exemption rests on the configuration as installed and tested, and it lapses for a configuration changed outside a governed act (Determination of 8 October 2026, A Protective Function Running Logic Other Than What Was Tested Is Not Covered by the Carve-Out).

7.3 The AI-Governance Design Basis: Named and Referenced

Machine-learning and generative-AI systems are entering the class: video analytics and intrusion detection; access control by face or credential; the screening of people, bags and mail; systems that lock down a building or release it; systems that detect and respond to intrusions into the government's networks, among them responses that isolate, wipe or restore systems; and assistants with access to a government's records and to its public communications. The framework names these and places the Bright Line for any action of a component within the scope of *Layer Decomposition and Determinism* §4.3 whose incorrect performance could compromise facility security or governance continuity at or above the severity threshold, with the architecturally enforced authorization of a qualified security official as Command Broker (framework §5). These systems are governed by the Bright Line and Command Broker architecture (framework §5) and by the Command Broker family, whose parent is CB-Framework_Cross_Sector (*Command Broker Framework*); CB-REG (*Command Broker Family Register*) is authoritative for the family's version state. The coordination class, CntlCo, is the locus at which the sector's placement and obligation are implemented (framework §3.5). Placement is by the consequence of each action, not by the component (*The Bright Line* §4.2, §4.3).

Four cases illustrate the application, and none of them is a placement by component. A system within scope that locks the doors of a building, or releases them, takes an action placed on its consequence, which can be to hold the occupants in with an attacker or to let the attacker through; a lockdown whose consequence can reach the threshold requires the authorization of the qualified human the coordination class names as Command Broker, and the release of egress on fire alarm is not taken from the locally sovereign function of Section 7.2 by any lockdown. A system within scope that admits a person takes, with the admission, one action placed on the consequence of admitting that person to that space. A system within scope that responds to an

intrusion by isolating, wiping or restoring a government's systems takes an action placed on its consequence, which can be the loss of records that cannot be restored; an action that deletes or overwrites the copies of essential records is placed on that consequence however routine its occasion. A response within a set of systems and actions already authorized may be discharged in advance under FD-BL-D1 (*Mode of Discharge*); a change to the set itself, being a change to the pre-authorized envelope, is excluded from advance discharge by that determination's rule R3. And a system within scope that issues a warning, an evacuation order or an all-clear to the occupants or the public takes an action placed on the consequence of the people moving, or not moving, on it.

Any output on which such an action is grounded carries the indication-integrity obligation of FD-BL-D2 (*Indication Integrity*): an alarm, a video analytic, an identification or a report that the government's systems are clean, any of which may have been altered, is not a basis for authorization until it can be corroborated. Where it cannot be corroborated through an independent path, the action it bears on does not proceed without in-the-moment Command Broker authorization, and no placement changes (framework §5). In this class the adversary who attacks a building or a network is often in a position to alter what its systems report, which is why the obligation binds here.

7.4 The Interaction Point: Lockdown and Restoration Under Attack

The two design bases meet where the facility's systems act on its people or its records while an attacker is present. The facility's systems must be architecturally incapable of executing an action requiring authorization that originates from a component within the scope of *Layer Decomposition and Determinism* §4.3 without Command Broker authorization. That obligation reaches each such action whose consequence meets the threshold, and the actions most likely to do so are the lockdown or release of a first-tier building, the admission of a person to a first-tier space, the deletion or overwriting of the copies of essential records, and a warning or all-clear to the occupants; each is placed on its own consequence. The physical design basis keeps the occupants able to escape whatever the networks do; the alternate site and the protected copies bound the governance chain; the AI-governance design basis guarantees that no proposing system can lock people in with an attacker, or destroy what cannot be rebuilt, where the consequence requires it, without a qualified human authorization the architecture can enforce.

7.5 Scope Boundary

This instrument states the physical design basis in full and names the AI-governance design basis without restating it. The Foundational Definitions own the Bright Line, its scope and its obligation; the Command Broker family owns the Command Broker; the coordination class owns the implementation of placement in the sector and the custodial standards; the judicial and election classes own their functions; Emergency Services owns the response; and the series of the substrate own their infrastructure. This instrument applies them to the facilities in which governments operate and keep themselves in being.

8. Cross-Sector Dependencies and Regulatory Context

8.1 What Depends on the Class: The Functioning of Government

The class's outward consequence is the functioning of government, felt across the whole of society rather than through a single service chain (framework §6.2). A government that cannot govern cannot coordinate the response to an emergency or the recovery of any other sector, cannot pay the benefits or issue the permits its people depend on, and cannot perform the acts on which the legitimacy of its successors rests. The symbolic consequence reaches further, to the confidence on which all of that depends.

8.2 What the Facility Depends On

The facility depends on energy for its buildings and systems; on communications for its networks and its services to the public; on information technology for the software and hardware on which its enterprise runs, whose supply chain is governed by *Software, Hardware and Product Supply Chain* (DBA-IT-SW-FC3); on transportation for the access of its employees and the public; and on water for its operation (framework §6.1). It depends on Emergency Services for the forces that answer an attack or a fire, governed by *Response Forces and Stations* (DBA-ESS-RF-FC2), and for the coordination of a wider emergency, governed by *Emergency Management and Coordination* (DBA-ESS-EMCo). And it depends on the coordination class of its own sector for the standards and protective forces that secure it.

8.3 The Boundaries with the Partner Classes and Series

Six boundaries are drawn. With *Judicial Facilities* (DBA-GF-JU-FC2): courthouses and the judicial function are that class's, and where a government's enterprise systems serve its courts, as Atlanta's served its municipal court, the court's function is that class's and the shared systems are both classes'. With *Election Infrastructure* (DBA-GF-EL-FC3): voting, tabulation, voter registration and election management are that class's, including the breach of the Illinois voter-registration system of 2016, which is held for it; the legislative act of counting electoral votes, being performed in a legislative seat under the law that schedules it, is this class's. With the coordination class, CntlCo: the custodial standards of the General Services Administration and the Interagency Security Committee, the Federal Protective Service, the continuity programs and the implementation of Bright Line placement in the sector are its. With Emergency Services: emergency operations centers and the forces that respond to an attack are that series' (framework §6.3). With the defense-industrial-base series: military installations and national laboratories are governed for their defense functions by that series (framework §6.3). With the surveillance and democratic-safeguards standard: whatever influence operation precedes or follows an attack on a seat of government is that standard's, and the attack on the facility, its people and its function is this class's (framework §6.3).

8.4 Regulatory and Institutional Context

The class is governed by facility-security and information-security standards rather than by an operating regulator (framework §2.1). The Department of Homeland Security and the General Services Administration are the co-Sector Risk Management Agencies, the role the framework calls Sector-Specific Agency. Executive Order 12977 of 19 October 1995 established the Interagency Security Committee, whose standards, among them *The Risk Management Process: An Interagency Security Committee Standard*, set the facility security level of a federal facility and the protective measures that level requires, and which descends from the Department of Justice's assessment of June 1995 that followed the Oklahoma City bombing. The General Services Administration owns and leases much of the federal civilian inventory through its Public Buildings Service and sets the design standards for its buildings, and the Federal Protective Service protects the facilities under its jurisdiction. The Department of Defense applies its Unified Facilities Criteria to its own installations. The Federal Information Security Modernization Act governs the security of federal information systems.

The continuity of the federal executive is governed by Presidential Policy Directive 40, *National Continuity Policy*, and by Federal Continuity Directives 1 and 2, which require each organization to identify its essential functions and to be able to perform them from an alternate site. The legislative branch provides for its own continuity and protection: at the Capitol, the Capitol Police under the Capitol Police Board, whose authority to request assistance Congress amended by the Capitol Police Emergency Assistance Act of 2021 (Public Law 117-77, enacted 22 December 2021), allowing the Chief of the Capitol Police to request assistance without the Board's prior approval when the Chief determines it necessary to prevent the significant disruption of governmental function and public order at the Capitol. State, local and tribal governments are bound by no federal facility-security standard; they protect their buildings under their own law and practice, and CISA offers them assessments, guidance and services that they may take up.

The regulatory gap is the framework's (framework §2.3). The apparatus measures security in levels, controls and plans. No instrument states the governance functions a facility must be shown able to sustain through a defined envelope of attack and disruption, crediting only alternate sites that have been used and restorations that have been tested; no instrument treats the authority to reinforce a protective force as a design-basis quantity; no instrument asks a local government to identify the records it could not rebuild; and the symbolic consequence has no design-basis treatment at all. This class states those as design-basis requirements for the tiers that carry the load.

9. Inheritance Map and Anticipated Derivatives

9.1 The Inheritance Map

The series requires every facility-class instrument to state, at first publication, which elements it inherits unchanged, which it inherits with adaptation, and which it defines locally. Facility-class instruments add the governance-function-specific consequence chain and, where applicable, the symbolic consequence (framework §8.1). Table 9-1 is the map for this class. Where the framework is a skeleton, the element is developed here and recorded for the framework to take up.

Table 9-1. Inheritance map for DBA-GF-GO-FC1.

Element	Source in the framework	Inheritance mode
Function-primary placement, GO function class	§1.3, §3.1, §3.2	Inherited unchanged
Level and classification sub-index	§3.1, §8.2	Inherited with adaptation; three continuity tiers and a separate symbolic overlay (Section 2.2)
Design-basis principles (governance-consequence severity, not likelihood)	§4.1	Inherited unchanged
Governance-continuity duration and symbolic consequence	§1.5, §3.6	Inherited; the life-safety chain added as Chain L (Section 3.2)
Governance-continuity duration at class resolution	§3.6	Locally defined as a parameter (Section 3.3); for the framework to take up
Event categories	§4.1 (candidates)	Developed here ahead of the framework; for the framework to take up
Bright Line and Command Broker architecture	§5; FD-BL; Command Broker family	Inherited with adaptation: lockdown, admission, record deletion and warnings placed on their consequence (Section 7.3)
The seat, the act and the records	§3.2	Locally defined (Section 4)
Continuity of Function and Protected Occupancy Conditions	§7 (skeleton)	Locally defined (Section 6.7)
Declared residuals and conditionality check	not yet in the framework	Locally defined; recorded for the framework (Sections 6.8, 6.9)

Element	Source in the framework	Inheritance mode
Boundaries with Emergency Services, the defense series and the surveillance standard	§6.3	Inherited unchanged and applied (Section 8.3)

9.2 Anticipated Derivatives

Facility-specific design bases inherit this class document by reference and add only what is locally specific, each carrying a recorded applicability determination for any scope it reduces. The three reference events this class proposed at v0.1, on the author's decision of 14 October 2026, are conferred by the framework at §9.1: DBA-GF-RE-1, *The Bombing of the Alfred P. Murrah Federal Building*, Oklahoma City, 19 April 1995 (Section 5.2); DBA-GF-RE-2, *The Breach of the United States Capitol*, 6 January 2021 (Section 5.3); and DBA-GF-RE-3, *The Ransomware Attack on the City of Atlanta*, March 2018 (Section 5.4). Their instruments were written by Project 11 on 14 October 2026, and this revision takes in their erratum and six recommendations. The plan for closing the seven sectors named the breach of the Illinois voter-registration system in 2016 for this sector; on the author's decision of 14 October 2026 it is held for *Election Infrastructure* (DBA-GF-EL-FC3). The facility-class use case for the governing military-action scenario of Section 6.3 is DBA-GF-UC-1, issued under this revision in the fifth wave of the plan.

10. Gaps and Open Items

10.1 Quantitative Design Parameters

The six parameters of Section 3.3 are stated without values. Their values for a facility are to be validated against the Interagency Security Committee's assessments, the organizations' continuity plans, CISA's assessments of state and local facilities and the facilities' own records. Some of those values are controlled or classified, and the location of a continuity site is often secret; a facility's design basis that states them must be held at the level of what it states. This instrument is written to be published, and states none.

10.2 The Symbolic Consequence

The framework declines a duration measure for the symbolic consequence and measures it by the significance of the site (framework §3.6), and records its development as an open item (framework §9). This instrument carries it as an overlay of three grades, national, state or regional, and none (Section 2.2), and declares it as a residual rather than bounding it (Section 6.8). Whether a design basis can do more than declare a consequence it cannot measure in time is for the framework, and the reading of the Capitol event, where the symbolic harm ran whether or not the act was completed, is its first test.

10.3 The Life-Safety Chain

The framework states two consequence measures, governance continuity and the symbolic consequence, and does not name harm to the people in a facility as a measure of its own (framework §3.6). This instrument separates it as Chain L because it is reached and bounded by different means. Whether the framework adopts the separation is for the framework.

10.4 Local Sovereignty in the DBA-MA Sense

Section 6.7 relies on locally sovereign protective functions for egress and fire protection, as FD-LS defines the property. Whether the DBA-MA parent framework's local-sovereignty principle is the same thing FD-LS defines remains the open question the other classes record.

10.5 The Agency's Name

The framework names the Department of Homeland Security the Sector-Specific Agency (framework §2.1). The role has since been renamed Sector Risk Management Agency, and the General Services Administration now shares it with the Department as a co-Sector Risk Management Agency. CISA now also calls the sector the Government Services and Facilities Sector. This instrument uses the current agency names and keeps the framework's name for the sector. The framework's usage is the framework's to conform at its next revision.

10.6 The Reference Events

The three reference events this class proposed are conferred by the framework at §9.1 as DBA-GF-RE-1 to DBA-GF-RE-3, and their instruments were written by Project 11 on 14 October 2026. Each records a non-military adversarial event: Oklahoma City a single domestic act, persistence and denial not present; the Capitol breach with precision and denial not determined, each official account stated as its authors' own and the record open; and Atlanta on a criminal record of two indictments, open, with no government role alleged. The instruments name no one responsible, name officials by role, and state each account as its authors'. None of them needed the class's type resolved. This revision takes in the erratum at Sections 2.4 and 5.2 and the recommendations at Sections 3.3, 4.2, 4.4 and 5.4. The use case for the governing scenario of Section 6.3 is DBA-GF-UC-1.

10.7 The Register Row

The DBA Facility Class Register now records this class at v0.1 as an issued working draft under the framework at v0.3, typed coordination; Project 0 lifted its hold on the type on the author's determination of 14 October 2026 (*Three Author Decisions: Continuity Classes, Vendor Releases and Staged Releases*).

10.8 The Framework's Date

The framework's cover reads August 2026 at v0.3, while its revision history records v0.3 as made in October 2026. The cover date is the framework's to correct at its next revision, which the conferral will be.

10.9 What This Class Notes to Other Instruments

Several elements of this instrument belong to other instruments, and this instrument records them as noted without stating them for those instruments. To the framework: the three chains and the life-safety chain in particular (Sections 3.2, 10.3), the six parameters and the governance-continuity duration at class resolution (Section 3.3), the continuity tiers and the symbolic overlay (Section 2.2), the event categories of Section 5, the two adequacy conditions of Section 6.7, the declared residuals of Section 6.8, the conditionality principle of Section 6.9, the agency's name (Section 10.5), and the cover date (Section 10.8); the conferral section it also asked for is now framework §9.1. To *Judicial Facilities* and *Election Infrastructure*, when written: the boundaries of Section 8.3, and to the election class the Illinois event held for it. To Emergency Services: the dependence of Section 8.2 and the boundary of Section 8.3. To *Software, Hardware and Product Supply Chain*: that the enterprise systems of local government are a dependent this class names. And to Project 0: the register row of Section 10.7. From the instruments: to the coordination class, CntlCo, when written, *The Bombing of the Alfred P. Murrah Federal Building* R-2 on placing those who cannot escape unaided and *The Breach of the United States Capitol* R-1 on the two chains of reinforcement; to *Response Forces and Stations*, *The Breach of the United States Capitol* R-1; to *Election Infrastructure*, when written, *The Breach of the United States Capitol* R-2 on the instruments of a time-bound act; and to *Judicial Facilities*, when written, and *Software, Hardware and Product Supply Chain*, *The Ransomware Attack on the City of Atlanta* R-2 on the inventory with criticality.

References

DBA-GF Series and Parent Framework

Government Facilities Sector Framework (DBA-GF_Sector_Framework). Eclectic Technologies, 2026. Parent sector framework under which this instrument is issued.

DBA-MA Parent Framework. Eclectic Technologies. Source of the design-basis-under-military-action methodology. FD-DBL (*Design Basis Layers*), held for the edition following the October 2026 Edition, is the canonical statement of the four military-action characteristics (§4.4, §6.4).

Defense in Depth (DBA-MA-DiD). Eclectic Technologies, 2026. Declared-residual output form (§3.5).

Defense Production and Sustainment (DBA-DIB-DP-FC1), *Care Delivery* (DBA-HPH-CD-FC1), *Response Forces and Stations* (DBA-ESS-RF-FC2), *Emergency Management and Coordination* (DBA-ESS-EMCo) and *Software, Hardware and Product Supply Chain* (DBA-IT-

SW-FC3). Eclectic Technologies, 2026. The structural models, the response to an attack, the coordination of a wider emergency, and the supply chain of the enterprise.

Facility-Class Types Are Physical, Coordination and Logical, author's determination of 30 September 2026, and *A Protective Function Running Logic Other Than What Was Tested Is Not Covered by the Carve-Out*, author's determination of 8 October 2026, both recorded by Project 0. *Closing the Seven Sectors*, working plan of 13 October 2026, Project 9. *Three Author Decisions: Continuity Classes, Vendor Releases and Staged Releases*, author's determination of 14 October 2026, recorded by Project 0.

The Bombing of the Alfred P. Murrah Federal Building (DBA-GF-RE-1), *The Breach of the United States Capitol* (DBA-GF-RE-2) and *The Ransomware Attack on the City of Atlanta* (DBA-GF-RE-3). Eclectic Technologies, 2026. Held by Project 11; conferred at Government Facilities Sector Framework §9.1 and cited by short title and finding or recommendation number. The RECORD PRIMACY convention of the DBA Reference Event Register, Project 0.

Foundational Definitions and Command Broker Family

FD-BL, FD-BR, FD-LD, FD-LS, FD-EV, FD-BL-D1 and FD-BL-D2, cited by designation; version state in FD-REG (*Governing Stack Register*). CB-Framework_Cross_Sector (*Command Broker Framework*), cited by designation; version state in CB-REG (*Command Broker Family Register*).

Regulatory, Standards and Guidance

Executive Order 12977, *Interagency Security Committee*, 19 October 1995. Interagency Security Committee. *The Risk Management Process: An Interagency Security Committee Standard*. United States Department of Justice. *Vulnerability Assessment of Federal Facilities*, 28 June 1995. Presidential Policy Directive 40, *National Continuity Policy*. Federal Emergency Management Agency. Federal Continuity Directive 1, *Federal Executive Branch National Continuity Program and Requirements*, January 2017, and Federal Continuity Directive 2. Capitol Police Emergency Assistance Act of 2021, Public Law 117-77, 22 December 2021, amending 2 U.S.C. 1970. Federal Information Security Modernization Act of 2014. Department of Defense Unified Facilities Criteria. Cybersecurity and Infrastructure Security Agency, *Government Facilities Sector*.

Events and Investigations

National Institute of Standards and Technology, *Oklahoma City Bombing (1995)*, summary of the investigation of the building's performance; Congressional Research Service, *The Interagency Security Committee and Security Standards for Federal Buildings* (RS22121); and contemporary reporting of the casualties, as reported by the Associated Press.

United States Senate, Committee on Homeland Security and Governmental Affairs and Committee on Rules and Administration. *Examining the U.S. Capitol Attack: A Review of the*

Security, Planning, and Response Failures on January 6, June 2021. United States Senate Press Gallery, floor log of 6 and 7 January 2021. House of Representatives, Select Committee to Investigate the January 6th Attack on the United States Capitol, *Final Report*, December 2022. House of Representatives, Committee on House Administration, Subcommittee on Oversight, report of December 2024. United States Department of Justice, statement of the Attorney General on the second anniversary of the event, January 2023. The President's grant of pardons and commutations of 20 January 2025. The White House, account of 6 January 2021, published January 2026.

City of Atlanta, statement of 23 March 2018 on the ransomware attack; contemporary reporting of the city's costs and losses. United States Department of Justice, remarks and announcement of 28 November 2018 on the indictment in the District of New Jersey of two Iranian nationals for the SamSam ransomware campaign.

Reporting of the damage to the building of Ukraine's Cabinet of Ministers in Kyiv, 7 September 2025, the statement of the Prime Minister of Ukraine and the statement of the Russian Ministry of Defense of the same day.

Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Description
0.1 — DRAFT	October 2026	Tim Roxey	Initial issue. First facility-class instrument in the DBA-GF series, typed physical under the author's determination of 30 September 2026, in the ten-section structure of DBA-HPH-CD-FC1 and DBA-DIB-DP-FC1. Written under the plan Closing the Seven Sectors, wave 4, on the author's decisions of 14 October 2026: Government Operations and Continuity as the sector's first class; three reference events proposed, the bombing of the Murrah Federal Building in Oklahoma City (1995), the breach of the Capitol (2021) and the ransomware attack on the City of Atlanta (2018), the last in place of the breach of the Illinois voter-registration system (2016), which is held for the election class. States the framework's governance-continuity and symbolic consequences for the government-operations function, adds a life-safety chain, states six parameters and two adequacy conditions, Continuity of Function and Protected Occupancy, and declares the symbolic consequence as a residual. Checked before issue by an independent review agent, not a person, against primary sources and for internal consistency; its substantive findings were taken in, among them the White House account of January 2026 stated in its own terms, the design-basis reading of the Capitol event rested on the Senate committees' report rather than attributed to every account, the select committee's central finding stated as its own, and the Russian Ministry of Defense's statement on the Kyiv strike added.

Version	Date	Author	Description
0.2 — DRAFT	October 2026	Tim Roxey	Conforms its type to coordination on the author's determination of 14 October 2026, which confirmed the type given on 30 September 2026; the treatment of the seat stays where it is, as the facility the coordination function runs from (Section 1.4). Conforms to the framework at v0.4 and takes in the return of Project 11's Government Facilities batch. The three reference events proposed at v0.1 are stated as conferred, as DBA-GF-RE-1 (Oklahoma City), DBA-GF-RE-2 (the Capitol) and DBA-GF-RE-3 (Atlanta), at Sections 1.3, 5.2, 5.3, 5.4, 6.2, 9.2 and 10.6. Erratum 1 gives the injured as the Oklahoma State Department of Health's 759 (Sections 2.4, 5.2). The optional refinements add the division of the dead and the charge's distance, the Board's approval at 2:10 p.m. and its members not fully understanding the requirements, the open record, the White House account's attributions as its page reads, and the Atlanta indictment (Sections 5.2 to 5.4). The six recommendations enter at Sections 3.3 (robustness in occupants; placing those who cannot escape; the two chains of reinforcement; no credit for payment; the inventory with criticality), 4.2 (the instruments of a time-bound act), 4.4 and 5.4. Section 10.9 carries the notings to CntlCo, Response Forces and Stations, Election Infrastructure, Judicial Facilities and the supply-chain class. The cover lineage stays as issued. No change to the class's scope, chains, parameters, event categories or residuals; the v0.1 entry is left as a record.